

Taylor Johnson

I build laboratory environments and infrastructure to create the conditions required for scientific discovery, and lead collaborative teams to execute end to end experimental and operational workflows from sample acquisition through publication.

Technical Core Competencies

- Experiment and operational workflow design
- Team building (hiring, training, management)
- Lab administration (BUA, IRB, asset procurement)
- Molecular biology & genomic assay development

Employment History

Staff Research Associate III at the University of California | San Francisco, CA.

2018 – present

- Wet lab:** Lab Manager working with [Dr. Jennifer Yokoyama](#) at the UCSF Fein Memory and Aging Center (MAC)
 - Lead and contribute to protocol and experimental design for genomic and molecular biology research studies from [pilot](#) to [global](#) scales
 - Technological expertise: Next-Generation Sequencing, droplet digital PCR, qPCR, flow cytometry, cryostat tissue sectioning, cell culture, clinical sample processing, nucleic acid and protein preparation/purification, QA/QC, clinical sample processing (human brain tissue, whole blood, CSF)
 - Built and operationalized a neurogenetics lab supporting multi-project genomic studies, established sample acquisition pipelines (human brain tissue, CSF cell, whole blood plasma), developed cross-lab collaborations and strategies to respond to and support the growing needs of the lab in terms of evolving research and logistical priorities.
 - Lead Operational Specialist (Interim) at the MAC Clinical Specimen Processing Lab (MAC SPL): Stabilized an operational crisis and emerged as a central figure for clinical trial sphere. Continuous liaison and core figure of the clinical sample processing team post-position
 - Management and administration for Yokoyama, Neuro Diagnostic, and MAC Clinical Specimen Processing lab groups: hiring, training, BUA authorship, logistical and operational lead, capital equipment assessment and procurement.
 - 2026 UCSF Office of Sustainability Awardee: Earned Gold-Level Sustainability Certification through proactive leadership, enhancing material procurement practices and establishing sustainable waste streams aligned with public health and environmental stewardship goals.
- Dry lab:** Analysis of datasets to support ongoing projects: proteomic, demographic, single cell RNA sequencing datasets
 - Computational proficiencies: R, bash, GitHub
 - Revived a retrospective cohort study leading to publication and [data sharing](#) effort.
 - Design, development, and maintenance of the Yokoyama Lab biorepository database (FreezerWorks LIMS) and [Sample Processing Proficiency Index](#) for complete biorepository tracking, maintenance and quality assessments.

Research Associate at California Polytechnic State University | San Luis Obispo, CA.

2017 – 2018

- Research Associate working with Dr. Marie Yeung
 - Probing Human Epithelial Cell Responses to Commercial Probiotic Bacterial Strains
 - Presented at the 2018 CSUPERB Biotechnology Research Symposium
 - Enhancing Recoverability of Lyophilized Lactic Acid Bacteria
 - Presented at the 2017 College of Science and Mathematics Student Research Conference

Education

California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo

2015 – 2018

- Bachelor of Science in Wine and Viticulture; concentration: Enology (GPA 3.65; Honors: Cum Laude)
- Minor: Microbiology
- Recipient of faculty awarded, Academic Scholar Grant (2018)

Santa Barbara City College

2011 – 2014

- Associate of the Arts in Science and Math (GPA 3.52; graduation with Honors)

Selected Publications & Presentations

Johnson, Taylor P., and Jennifer S. Yokoyama. "[Dried Plasma Spot Biomarker Test for Alzheimer's Disease Population Screening Using qPCR Systems](#)." Taudia, 10 Mar. 2026.

Johnson, Taylor P., et al. [Reduced Levels of Angiogenesis Biomarkers Predict Increased Symptom Severity in Chinese Americans with Alzheimer's Disease with Demographic-Specific Effect](#), 9 Feb. 2025, doi.org/10.1080/13554794.2025.2455759